



Solar system inside bubble?

Scientists at the University of Chicago hypothesize that our solar system formed inside a massive space bubble produced by a star. <http://dgit.in/SpaceBubl>



SpaceX caps record year

SpaceX has completed its 18th launch in 2017, marking a record year for the private space company. <http://dgit.in/SpacX18>



Credit: SovietRakMuseum

Belka and Strelka

Dogs were still being chosen for random spaceflights with stray dogs still making the cut. But none of them had ever survived while on their journey back to Earth. The Sputnik 5 mission became a monumental mission in space exploration when all the passengers came back to Earth alive. The most important travellers included two special dogs Belka and

Strelka. They made history on August 19, 1960, becoming two among the many living beings to survive a journey to orbit and back to Earth. This mission boosted everyone's confidence that we were close to having a manned-space mission soon. The other passengers included 42 mice, two rats, a gray rabbit and fruit flies. Quite an ensemble!

Able and Baker

Able, a rhesus monkey, and Baker, a squirrel monkey, were launched on a Jupiter missile to a sub-orbital flight on May 28, 1959. They safely landed, becoming the first animals to survive a spaceflight mission. However, Able died after four days during a surgery. On the other hand, Baker lived a healthy life till the age of 27. Fun fact: The space monkey in the Night at the Museum: Battle of the Smithsonian was based on Able.



Credit: National Air and Space Museum Archives

Ham and Enos

Manned spaceflight missions owe a good deal to two chimpanzees named Ham and Enos. Ham became the first chimp in space on January 31, 1961, while on a sub-orbital trajectory in a Mercury Redstone rocket. Ham survived the mission and the journey to Earth, depicted in the picture with the recovery ship commander in the famous "hand shake" gesture. This mission was followed by Alan Shepherd, who was the first American to travel to a sub-orbital path. After Ham, Enos became the first chimp to orbit Earth on November 29, 1961. The mission was planned for three orbits but due to overheating issues and a malfunctioning test, it was aborted.



Credit: NASA



Felicette

When it came to sending animals into space, the Soviet union frequently kept sending dogs while the US experimented with chimps. While both the nations were battling the space race, France's Centre national d'études sent a cat named Felicette into space. On October 18, 1963, the liquid-fueled French Véronique AG1 rocket took the feline subject to a height of 156 kilometres which was a non-orbital mission. She landed on Earth safely and was the only cat to be sent to space.

Veterok and Ugolyok

Dogs being the most popular candidates for space missions by the Soviet Union, they hold the most records. Holding the record for the longest space flight duration, the two canines Veterok and Ugolyok, spent 22 days orbiting the Earth. They were sent into orbit to study the effects of radiation as they travelled through the Van Allen radiation belt. After successfully completing their mission, they landed safely on March 16, 1966. Both of them still hold the record to this day. 🇷🇺

